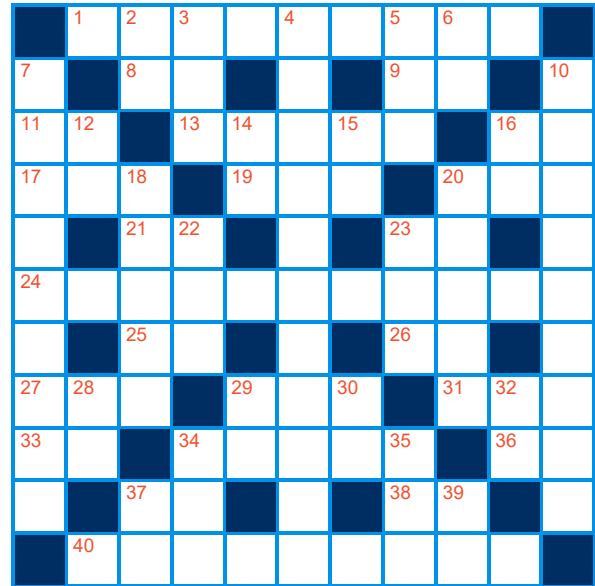


Across

- 1 Defenders can no longer legally touch a shot ball after it has bounced off of this. (9)
- 8 The tallest WNBA Player, who sat out the most recent season in her homeland of China. (2)
- 9 Augustin, Wilson, or spinner of records. (2)
- 11 In the event that. (2)
- 13 Aside from the stepback, James Harden's most distinguishable feature. (5)
- 16 Initials of the lights out shooting guard who spaced the floor for the Kemp/Payton Sonics in their heyday. (2)
- 17 What Gerald Green has on his shooting hand, instead of a ring finger. (3)
- 19 Slang for disregarding which person is involved. (3)
- 20 The hours in which many international NBA fans have to watch live games. (3)
- 21 Alright. (2)
- 23 See 26
- 24 This *big* made his only All-NBA (third) team in 2014, one of three seasons in which he averaged over 20 points and 10 rebounds per game. (11)
- 25 Yes (2)
- 26/23 Meme caption almost as rudimentary as "same". (2,2)
- 27 A quaint lodging that a traveling NBA player would be unlikely to stay in. (3)
- 29 DNP-____, the official reason Gregg Popovich occasionally gave to sit Tim Duncan. (3)
- 31 What you do with more than 1 seed. (3)
- 33 Briefly, a break from the action. (2)
- 34 Bavetta and Vitale. (5)
- 36 "Majestic plural" is another term for the royal _____. (2)
- 37 Briefly, the player whose return Brooklyn has tied its fate to. (2)
- 38 Briefly, the one whose GOAT status is being increasingly called into question. (2)
- 40 Nickname that 37 Across said he didn't like, but used enough to get sued by someone else holding its trademark. (9)

Down

- 2 Alternative verb to "fire" a coach. (2)
- 3 Baby version of the Memphis and Minnesota mascots. (3)
- 4 Harrison Barnes' nickname. (11)
- 5 Subtract's opposite. (3)
- 6 While there are several juniors dotting the league, there are only two players with these similar first-name initials. (2)



- 7 The craze Jeremy's early 2012 in New York inspired. (9)
- 10 What is Allen Iverson's nickname in relation to this clue? (9)
- 12 In slang, the kind of money that precludes you from having to care what anyone thinks. (2)
- 14 Initials of the bouncy big who has played as a backup for the Blazers, Nets, and Jazz the last three seasons. (2)
- 15 The Time Lord's initials. (2)
- 16 Pronoun universal to NBA rosters, but not personnel. (2)
- 18 The most eastern Bogdonovic, when talking team city. (5)
- 20 Jerry, David, and Delonte. (5)
- 22 You'll get whistled for spending more than three in the _____. (3)
- 23 The kind of scan fans hope comes back negative for players under the hood. (3)
- 28 Will anyone finish this puzzle in under a minute (without hints)? (2)
- 29 What a Brit might shout instead of an aggressive "Hey!" (2)
- 30 Initials of the hairy foe to the Nintendo hero namesake of Chalmers and Hezonja. (2)
- 32 What a player might exclaim when the recipient of a flagrant foul. (2)
- 34 Briefly, the Konami classic in which a player might twirl, rotate, and and turn while tapping their feet in the arcade. (3)
- 35 In addition to the first in their names, Sterling, Shake, and Semi all share these initials for their alma mater. (3)
- 37 There are currently 29 active players in the NBA from this college powerhouse. (2)
- 39 Initials for the protagonist of 7 Down. (2)